

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♠

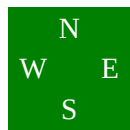
Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 3
♥ Q 9 5
♦ J 9 8 6
♣ A 7 3

♠ A 8 2
♥ A 10 8 2
♦ A 3
♣ K Q 10 4



♠ K J 9 6 4
♥ J 7 3
♦ 10 5 2
♣ 5 2

♠ 7 5
♥ K 6 4
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ J 9 8 6

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North continuation. You win the third ♠ with your ♠A.

Partner's 2NT bid invites you to bid game if you have a maximum hand. Your 17 points is certainly a maximum so you bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠6. Will you take your ♠A immediately? or at trick 2? or trick 3?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more tricks, and they must come from ♣s. So you must drive out the ♣A. The problem is that when the defenders win the ♣A they may also take 4 ♠ tricks.

While you cannot guarantee the contract you can at least give yourself a better chance by holding up your ♠A on the first trick, and also on West's ♠.

Now you drive out the ♣A. There are four possibilities: East may win the ♣A and cash two more ♠s, down 1. East may win the ♣A and cash just one ♠s, you make it. West may win the ♣A and have a fourth ♠ to lead, you make it. West may win the ♣A and be out of ♠s, you make it.

If you win the first or second ♠ trick you will fail. When you attack ♣s, West will win the ♣A and play a ♠.

Holding up twice can never hurt, and in this case it is the only way to make the contract.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 9 8 6 4 2

♥ 4

♦ K 6 5 3

♣ 8 3

♠ K 7

♥ J 10 9 8

♦ J 9 7 2

♣ Q 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 2

♦ A Q 4

♣ A J 7 4

♠ A Q 3

♥ K 7 5 3

♦ 10 8

♣ K 10 6 2

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

All Pass

2♠ by East

5Count losers in the long-trump hand, (dummy this time).

In the pre-transfer days you would have bid 2♠ with this hand and partner would have passed. Now you make partner bid the ♠s first by saying 2♥. Partner dutifully replies 2♠.

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You say pass.

The contract would be 2♠ played by West.

East plays 2♠. South leads the ♣2. North plays the ♣Q which you take with your ♣A.

Loser List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total =

You can make the contract if you just force out their big trumps. But there is another tempting possibility. You could enter dummy with the ♦K and play the ♥4, finessing North for the ♥K. If the finesse is successful you could then discard dummy's ♣ loser on the ♥A.

Should you or shouldn't you?

The reward for this play would be an overtrick. The price of failure would be going down in a cold contract. So obviously, at rubber bridge, you would be foolish to take such a risk. Playing Duplicate though, you **might** consider it. But let's say you decide to play safe.

Win the ♣A and play a trump. As soon as you get in play another trump. The defenders will no doubt take their ♣ winner when they get in. North will no doubt win one of those high trump tricks, and he MAY lead a ♥ when he gets in. There you will be, trying to decide again whether to finesse . . .

As you see, the ♥K is in the wrong place this time, but might be right the next time.

Usually you should not risk your contract for the sake of an overtrick.